ESHERIA

LEGAL WORKFLOW OPERATING SYSTEM

From Fragmented Capabilities to a Legal Workflow OS.

The strategic case for platform-first legal AI.

Esheria moves from product-fragmented legal AI capabilities to a unified multi-tenant operating system with orchestration, shared canonical objects, governance controls, and institutional audit trails. This proposal lays out the business rationale, architecture model, pilot roadmap, and decision package required for board-level alignment.

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// EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Platform Shift

Esheria currently operates five strong legal AI capabilities: document OCR and ingestion, contract compliance analysis, legal research and retrieval, AI-assisted drafting, and analytics infrastructure. Each is useful in isolation. Enterprise value, however, is constrained by fragmentation across identity, workflow state, data model, and governance controls.

This proposal recommends a platform-first transition: not rebuilding existing systems, but orchestrating them as one multi-tenant legal workflow operating system with canonical legal objects, policy-aware workflow automation, human-review checkpoints, and institutional analytics.

> // KEY INSIGHT
>
> *The strategic moat does not come from adding one more feature. It comes from owning the operating layer where enterprise legal work is executed, reviewed, audited, and improved over time.*

01 The Strategic Problem

Why five capabilities without a platform creates a growth ceiling

Current State Diagnosis

The current state shows capability fragmentation at exactly the points where enterprise buyers require consistency: identity, object model, workflow continuity, and accountability. The consequence is that each capability can be demonstrated, but the full legal workflow cannot be sold as one governed platform outcome.

Commercial Consequences If Left Unaddressed

- Sales cycles lengthen because each capability must be justified independently.
- Security and procurement reviews become repetitive because controls differ by surface.
- Product value appears additive rather than compounding.
- Institution-level reporting remains weak because data is not workflow-native.

What Enterprise Buyers Actually Need

Enterprise Requirement	Esheria Current Position
Repeatable, auditable workflows	Features without shared workflow state
Role-based access and controls	Varies by product surface
DMS, CRM, ERP integrations	Not yet systematised across services
Approval chains and escalation	Not present as platform primitives
Institution-facing analytics	Internal to Esheria operations only
Evidence-backed AI outputs	Output-only, weak citation traceability
Compliance and audit trails	Not yet implemented as a first-class platform concern

// ENTERPRISE WORKFLOW IMPERATIVE

Upload a contract. Analyse it. Flag risk. Draft responses. Route for review. Enforce SLA. Record rationale. Produce compliance evidence. Enterprises buy this complete chain, not disconnected steps.

02 The Platform Thesis

Orchestration-first integration with governance, tenancy, and audit

From Features to Operating Layer

The strategic thesis is a category move: Esheria evolves from a collection of legal AI features into a programmable legal operations platform. Existing services remain intact as Layer 1; platform value is created by adding orchestration, object consistency, policy controls, and measurable institutional outcomes above them.

Platform Capabilities

Component	Description
Canonical Object Model	Shared legal business objects used across all services, operators, and UIs.
Workflow Engine	Stateful step orchestration with routing, approvals, escalations, and SLA timers.
Connector Gateway	Stable mediation point between platform and capability services.
Multi-Tenant Core	Org isolation, role model, policy scopes, and environment governance.
Institution Analytics	Customer-facing workflow intelligence separate from internal operations analytics.

Operating Principles

- **Schema-first delivery:** object contracts are locked before feature expansion.
- **Control/data separation:** decision logic is isolated from data movement paths.
- **Policy traceability:** each automated action is linked to policy and evidence.
- **Tenant-safe observability:** monitoring exists at both global and institution scopes.

03 Platform Architecture

Five-layer stack — existing services connected, not rebuilt

The platform is structured as five bounded layers with explicit contracts and no non-adjacent dependencies.

Layer	Name	Purpose	Key Components
L5	**Experience**	Customer and operator surfaces	Institution Workspace, Operator Console, Public Surface
L4	**Control Plane**	Orchestration, governance, audit	Workflow Engine, Router, SLA Manager, Audit Log
L3	**Object Model**	Canonical legal entities	Org, Matter, Document, Clause, Risk, WorkflowRun, Action
L2	**Connectors**	Stable service mediation	OCR, Contract, Research, Drafting, Analytics connectors
L1	**Existing Services**	Current repos unchanged	esheria-ocr, contract-engine, esheria-ai, lexdraft, analytics

Architecture Guardrails

Guardrail	Enforcement Rule
API Boundary	Frontends call only `/api/*`; service calls route through `/internal/*`.
Version Discipline	Schema changes require versioning and migration contract documentation.
Audit Completeness	Every workflow state transition writes immutable event records.
Tenant Isolation	No cross-tenant reads without explicit operator authorization pathway.

04 The MVP: Contract Intake & Review

One workflow across all five services. One audit trail.

The Phase 2 MVP proves the full orchestration thesis through one commercially meaningful workflow: Contract Intake and Review.

End-to-End Workflow — 10 Steps

Step	Actor	Action	Output Object
01	**User**	Upload contract document	`Document + WorkflowRun`
02	**Ingestion Op**	OCR + validate + classify	`Parsed text, DocumentVersion`
03	**Extraction Op**	Extract clauses, parties, obligations	`Clause[] on Document`
04	**Compliance Op**	Check policies and regulations	`Risk[] with severity`
05	**Research Op**	Retrieve precedents + citations	`Citation[] linked`
06	**Drafting Op**	Generate fallback language	`Draft suggestions`
07	**Review Op**	Compile briefing + score risk	`Review record`
08	**Human Reviewer**	Decide + annotate	`Decision on Review`
09	**Routing Op**	Approve or escalate + enforce SLA	`Approval + SLA`
10	**Analytics Op**	Emit events + update dashboards	`Analytics updated`

MVP Success Criteria (Pilot-Ready)

Acceptance Criterion	Definition of Done
Workflow Completion Reliability	>95% successful end-to-end runs across pilot scenarios.
Audit Trace Completeness	100% of steps produce actor, timestamp, decision, and evidence references.
Human Review Efficiency	Reviewer decision cycle time reduced by at least 30% vs baseline.
SLA Compliance Visibility	Operators can detect and triage SLA breaches within dashboard views.

MVP Surface Snapshots

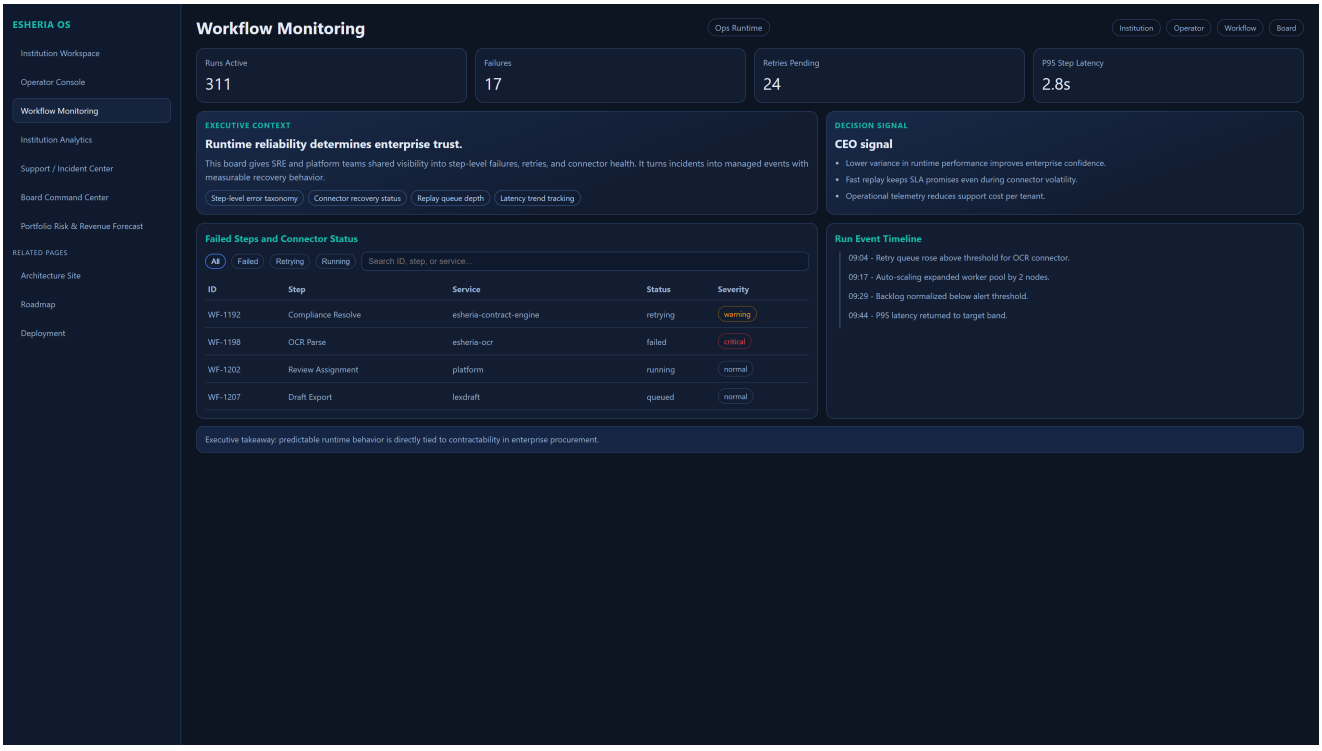

Figure 1: *

MVP Surface — Workflow Monitoring for state visibility and SLA management

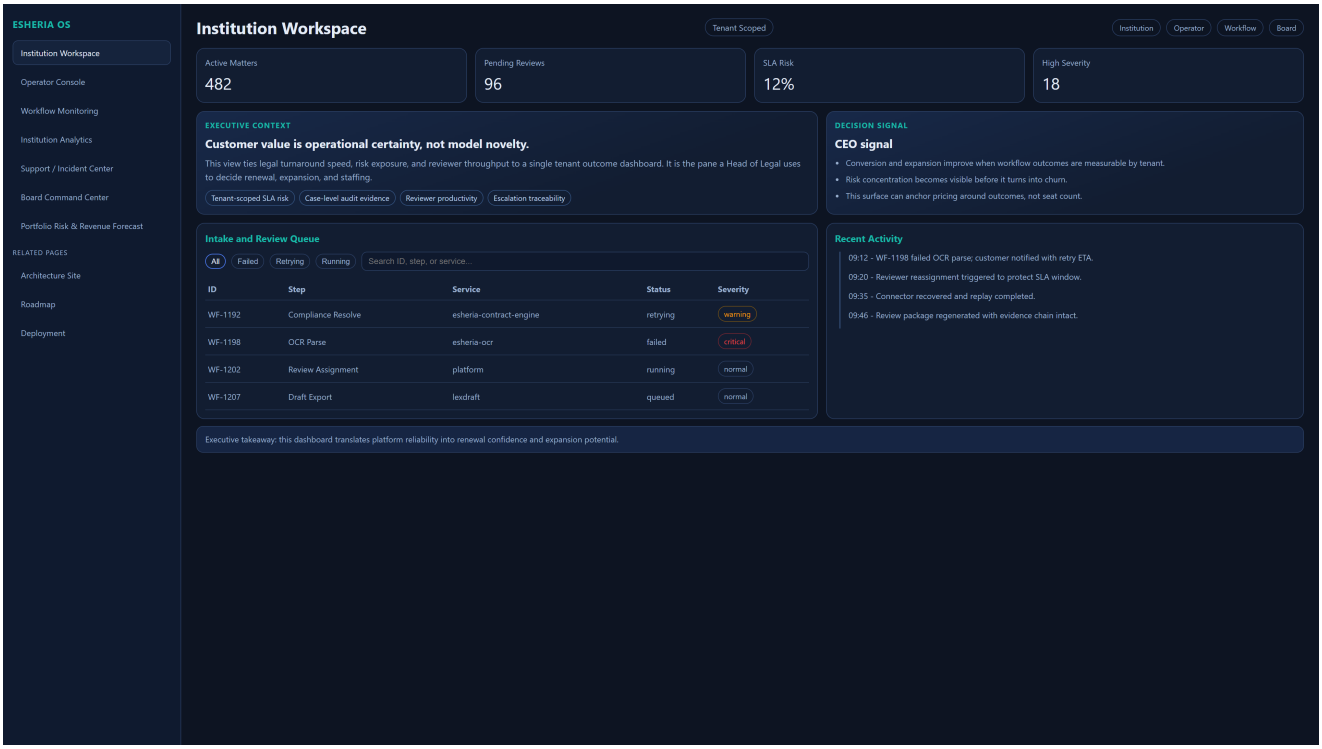

Figure 2: *

MVP Surface — Institution Workspace for reviewer workflow execution

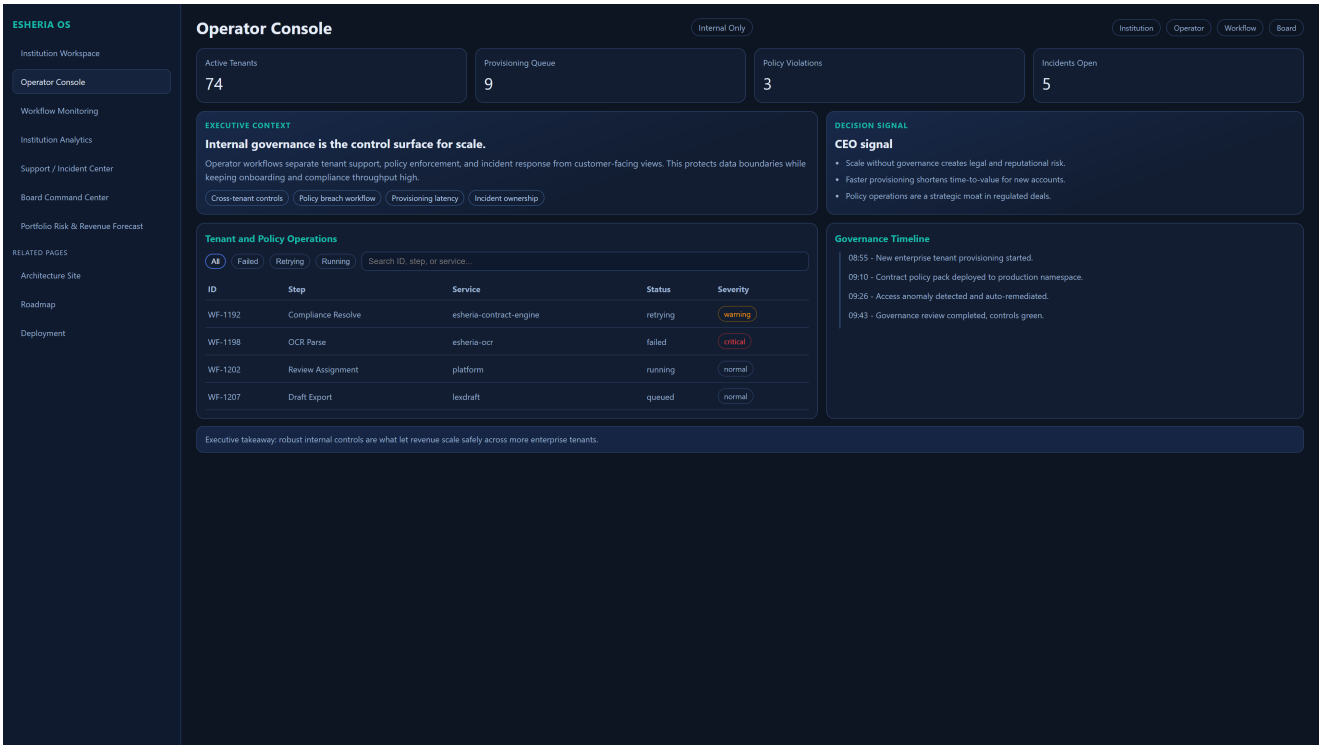

Figure 3: *

MVP Surface — Operator Console for governance and operational control

05 Decision Metrics

Four measurements that define the before and after

Metric	Current State	Target State
Workflow Throughput	Per-service, per-capability API outputs	End-to-end per tenant: matters closed and SLA compliance
Compliance Assurance	Point-in-time checks, fragmented evidence	Workflow-level evidence chain from clause to decision
Platform Leverage	Feature-level value with weak compounding	Workflow depth and integration footprint drive retention
Enterprise Sales Motion	Individual user acquisition	Org-level subscription tied to legal operations outcomes

Measurement Cadence and Ownership

Metric	Cadence	Owner	Reporting Output
Throughput	Weekly	Product Ops	Tenant-level run completion and cycle-time trend
Compliance	Weekly	Legal + Risk	Evidence integrity and audit readiness score
Adoption	Monthly	GTM + CS	Workflow activation, role adoption, and seat depth
Reliability	Daily	Platform Eng	Error budget, SLA breaches, and recovery time

06 Phased Roadmap

18 to 27 weeks from greenlight to first B2B pilot

Phase	Name	Duration	Key Deliverables	Exit Milestone
P0	**Validation**	2–3 wks	Alignment, scope lock, service readiness audit, KPI baseline	**Greenlight + scope agreed**
P1	**Design**	3–4 wks	Canonical schema, state model, API contracts, auth model	**Architecture sign-off**
P2	**MVP Build**	6–8 wks	Core backend, workflow engine, connectors, reviewer UI v1	**End-to-end live demo**
P3	**Pilot**	3–4 wks	Scenario tests, operator runbook, reliability baseline	**Pilot validation report**
P4	**B2B Launch**	4–6 wks	Target ICP, onboarding flow, pricing model, analytics pack	**First pilot conversation**

Delivery Governance

Each phase ends with a formal checkpoint reviewing architecture compliance, KPI movement, and cross-functional readiness. This prevents scope drift and ensures that commercial packaging evolves in lockstep with platform maturity.

07 The Ask

Four decisions — not a full platform rebuild

#	Decision	Why It Matters Now
1	**Strategic Alignment**	Confirms platform direction as the primary growth thesis for B2B expansion.
2	**MVP Greenlight**	Funds and authorizes P0–P2 to produce proof of orchestration value.
3	**Platform Ownership**	Assigns one accountable owner for cross-repo delivery and sequencing.
4	**Pilot Target Definition**	Anchors build decisions to a concrete customer profile and buying motion.

// CLOSING STATEMENT

The request is not to rebuild what exists. The request is to unify what exists into one coherent, governed, enterprise-ready legal workflow platform.

// SUPPORTING DOCUMENTATION

Full Reference Package

Document	Contents	Audience
Technical Architecture Blueprint	Five-layer architecture, deployment topology, API contracts, tenancy model, implementation guidance	Engineering, CTO
Architecture Diagram Pack	System context, layered architecture, workflow sequence, topology, integration and roadmap diagrams	Engineering + Product
Product and Design Appendix	Surface-level flows for Institution Workspace, Operator Console, Monitoring, Analytics, Support	Product, Design, Engineering
Consistency Report	Canonical architecture decisions, resolved inconsistencies, and assumptions register	Engineering Leads

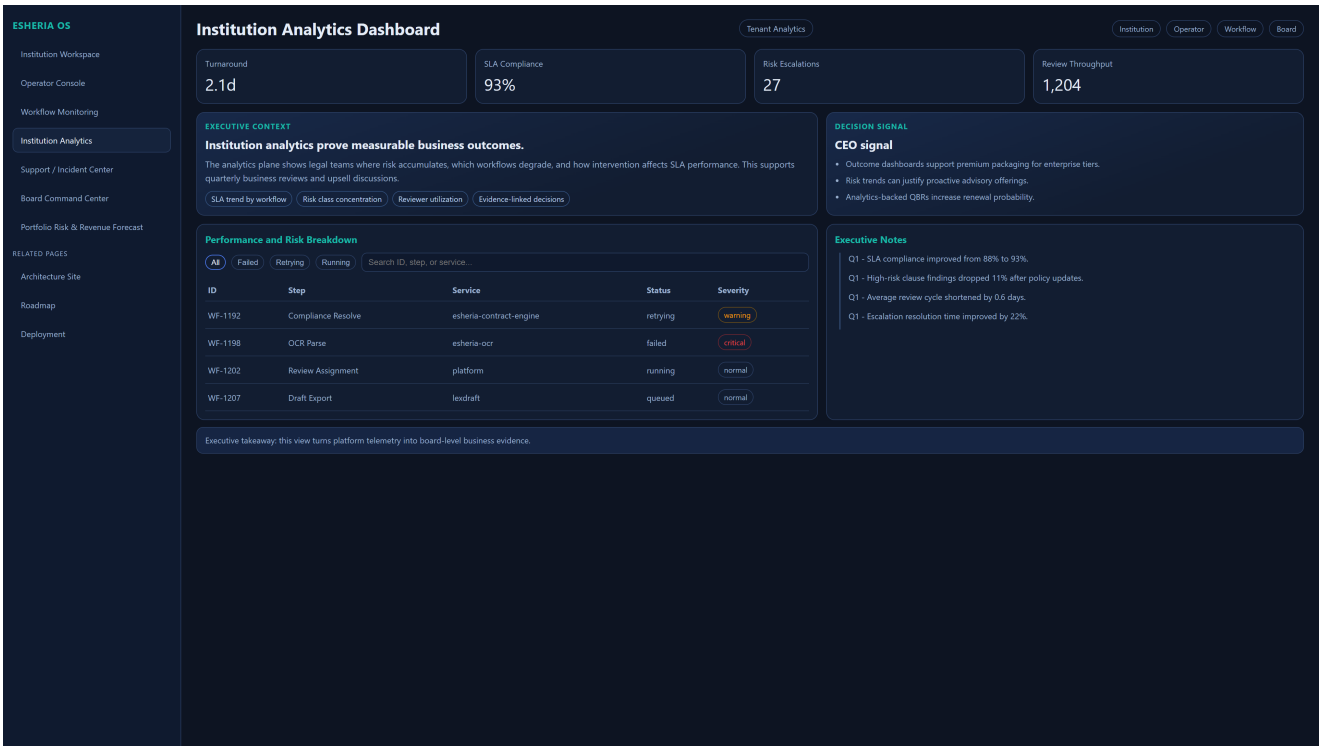

Figure 4: *

Institution Analytics Preview — tenant-facing performance and compliance intelligence

A

Current Architecture

System context — actors, platform services, and external integrations

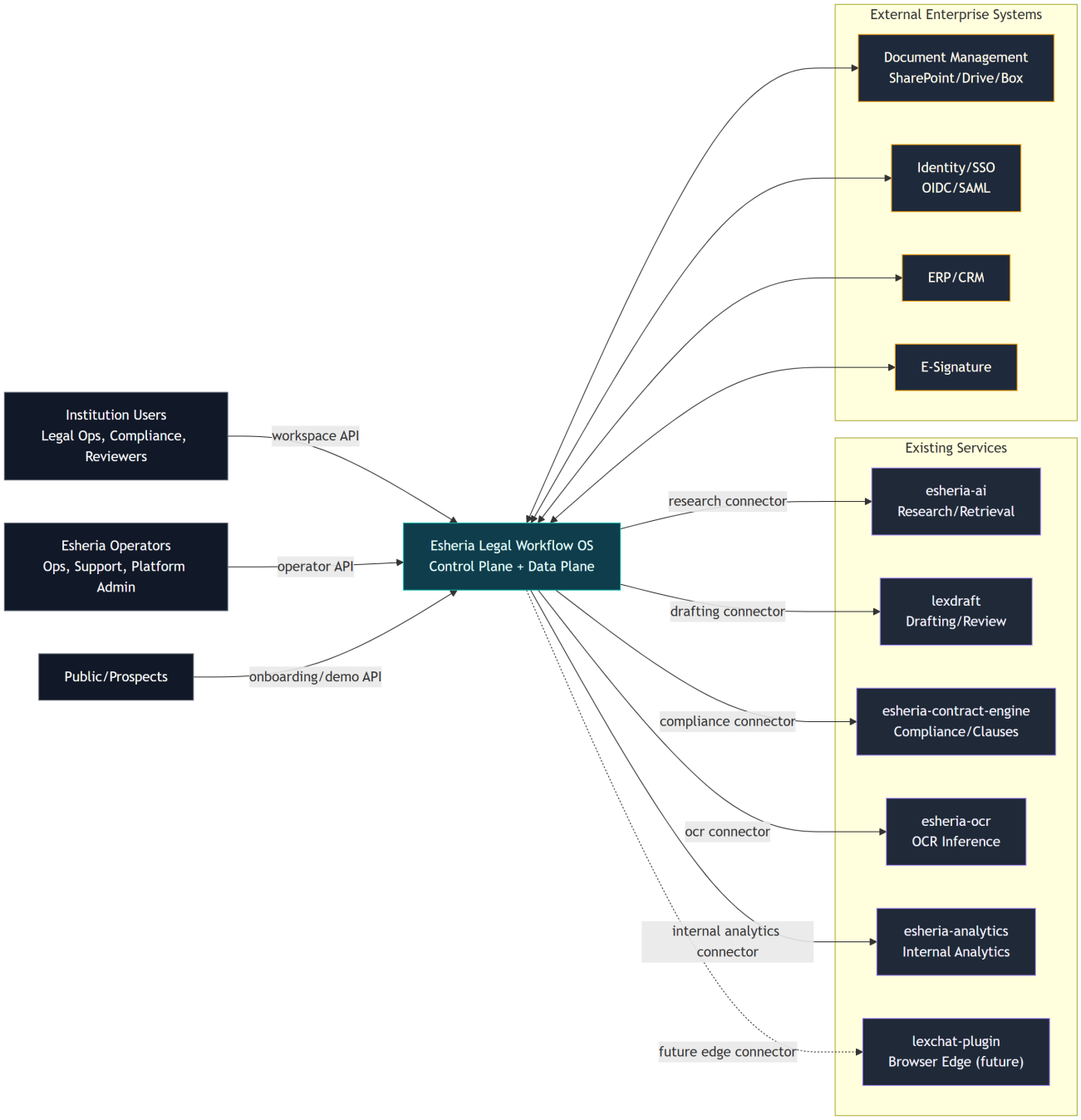

Figure 5: *

Figure A — System context across actors, services, and integrations

Executive Interpretation

This view defines the trust perimeter and clarifies where identity, access, and integration governance must be enforced.

B

Platform Architecture

Target layered architecture with control/data separation

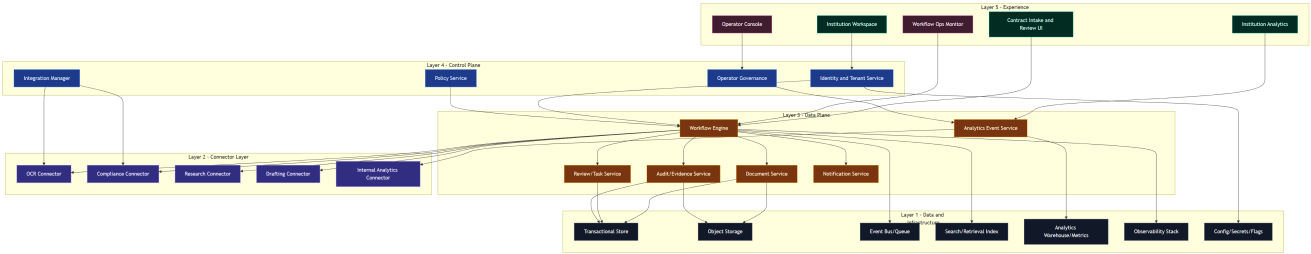

Figure 6: *

Figure B — Five-layer architecture from services to experience surfaces

Executive Interpretation

Layer boundaries prevent coupling and allow independent scaling of user experience, orchestration logic, and service connectors.

C Contract Intake Workflow

End-to-end sequence for Phase 2 MVP

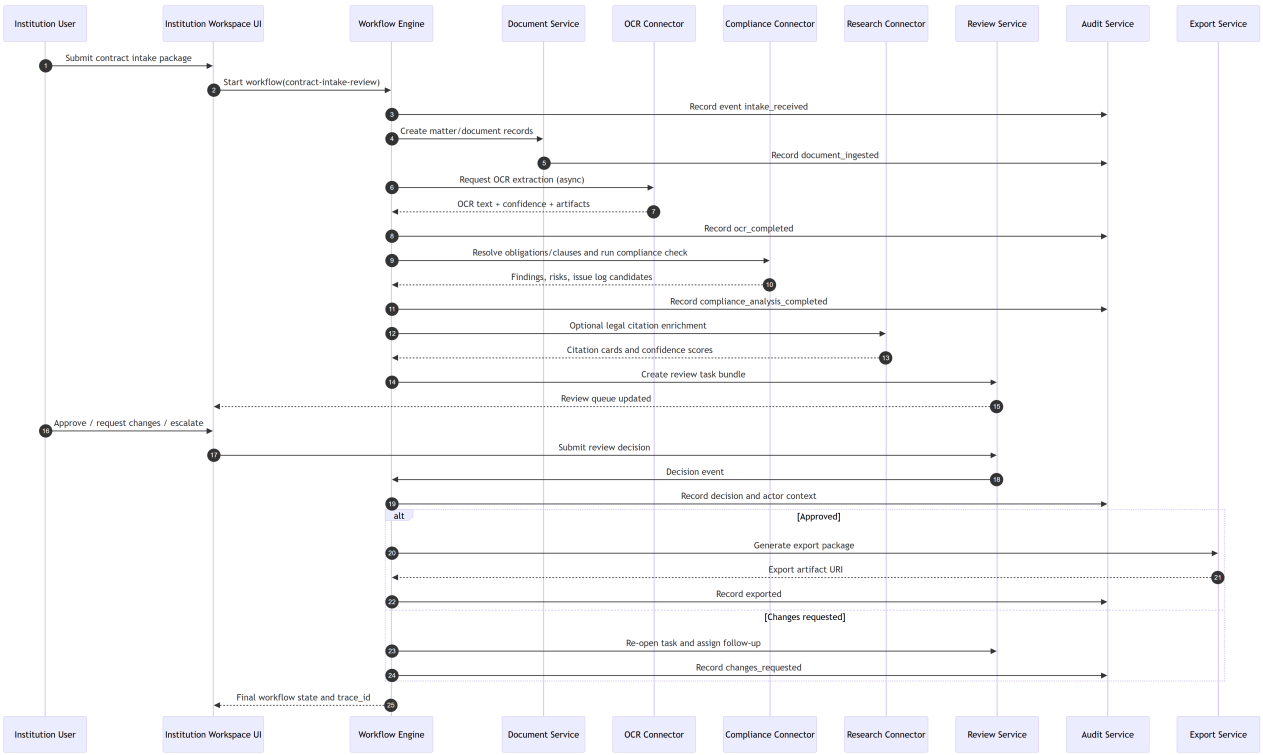

Figure 7: *

Figure C — Contract intake and review sequence across operators and human reviewer

Executive Interpretation

The workflow demonstrates measurable orchestration value and audit continuity in a single commercial scenario.

D Dashboard Topology

Customer vs operator surfaces and analytics domain separation

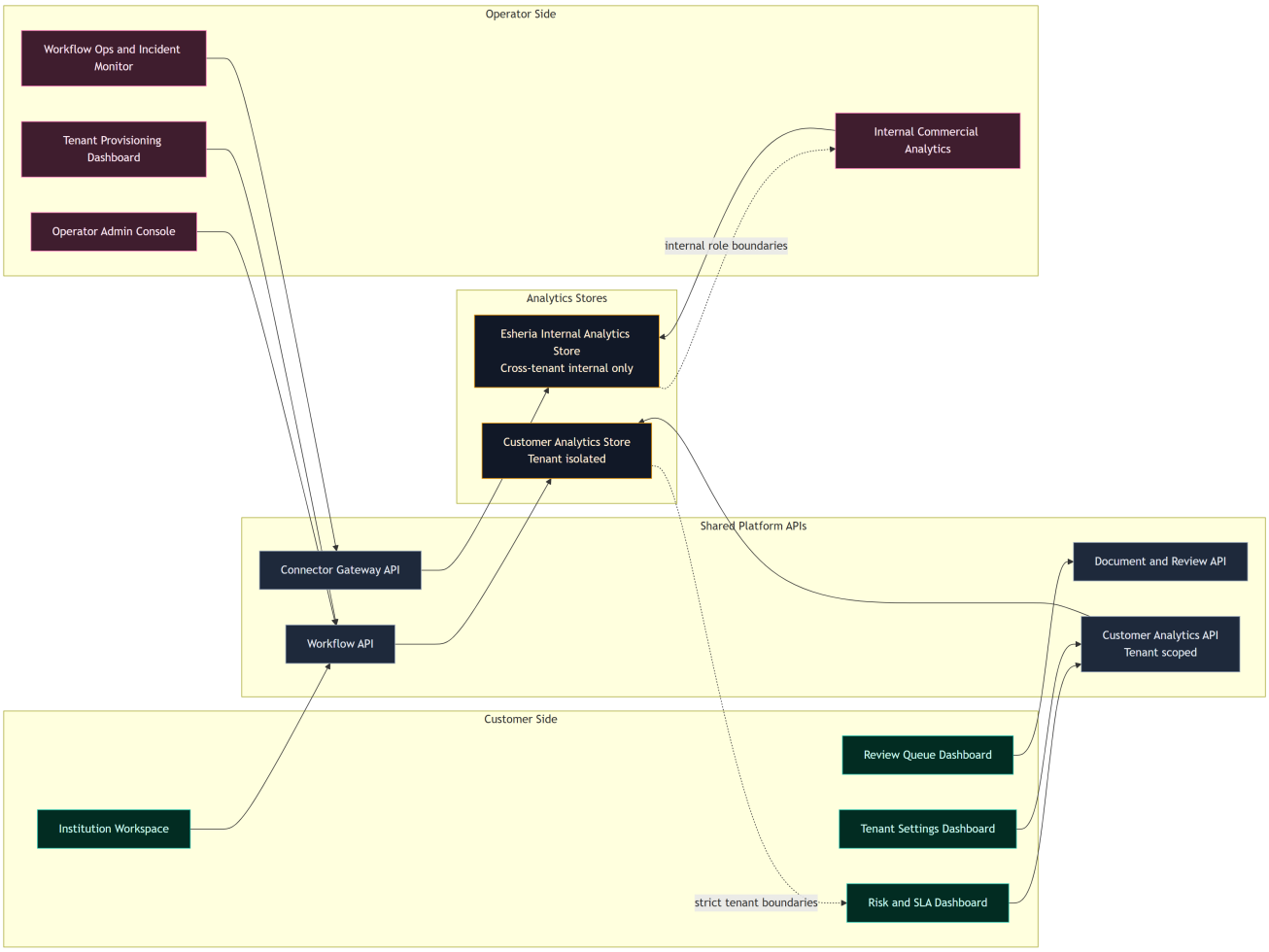

Figure 8: *

Figure D — Distinct dashboard surfaces with separate auth and data scopes

Executive Interpretation

Product and operations concerns are intentionally separated to protect tenant trust while preserving platform control.

E

Service Integration Map

Connector gateway routing across all capability services

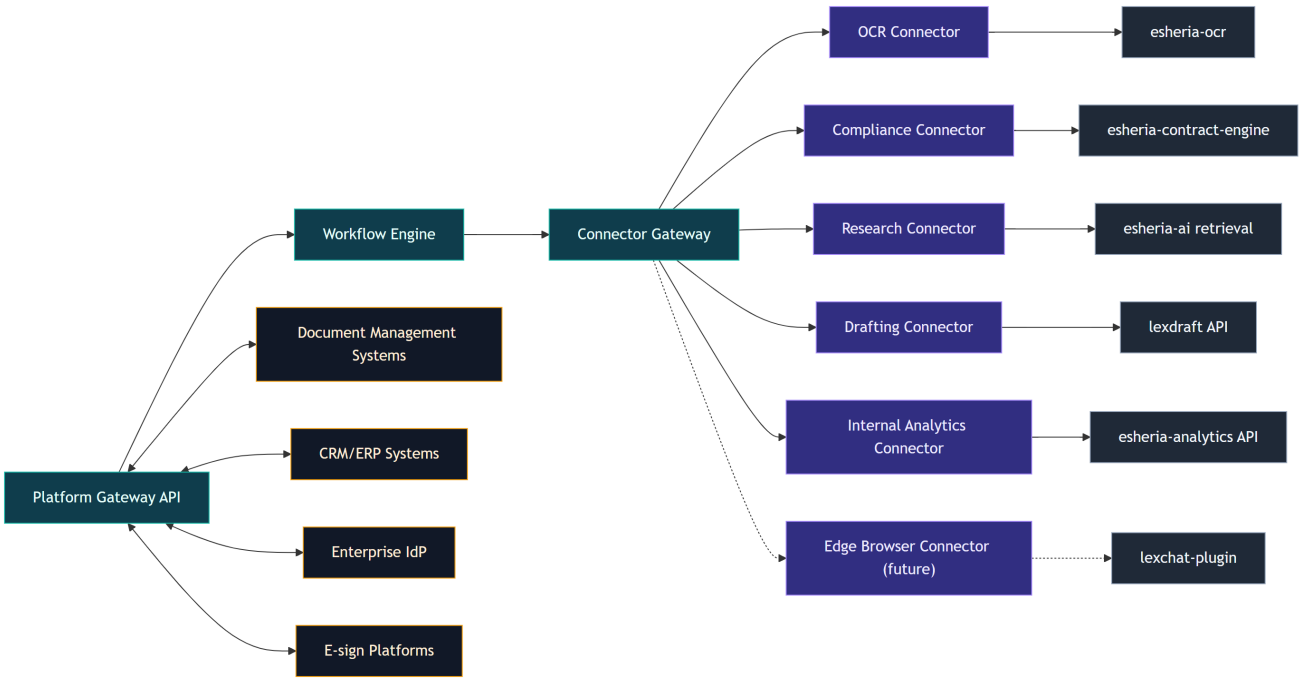

Figure 9: *

Figure E — Connector gateway routes all internal platform-to-service calls

Executive Interpretation

A single connector gateway centralizes resilience, auth handling, and contract normalization for downstream services.

F

Deployment Topology

Infrastructure stack, service boundaries, and data stores

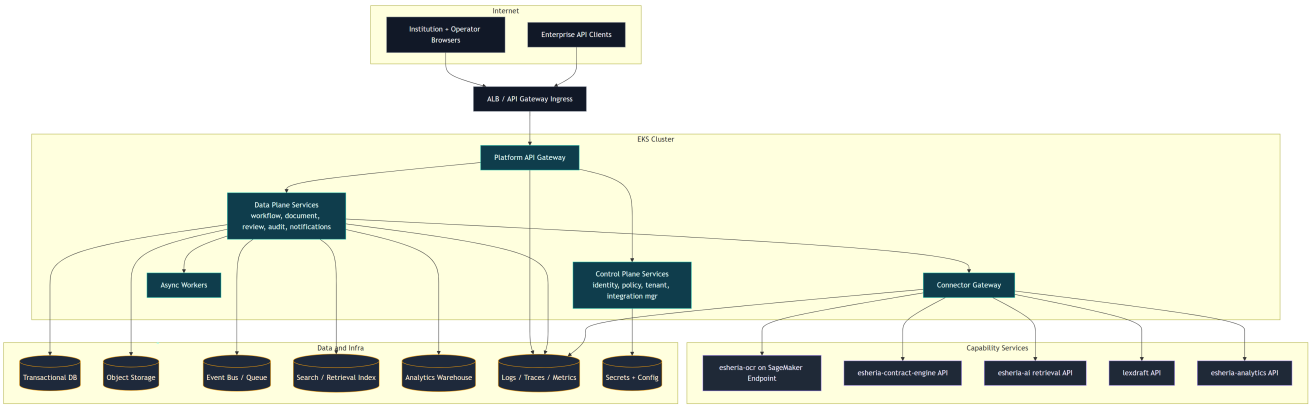

Figure 10: *

Figure F — Deployment topology for API gateway, backend, queue, and storage

Executive Interpretation

The topology balances security, scalability, and operational observability needed for enterprise pilot readiness.

G Transformation Roadmap

Architecture evolution from current state to target platform

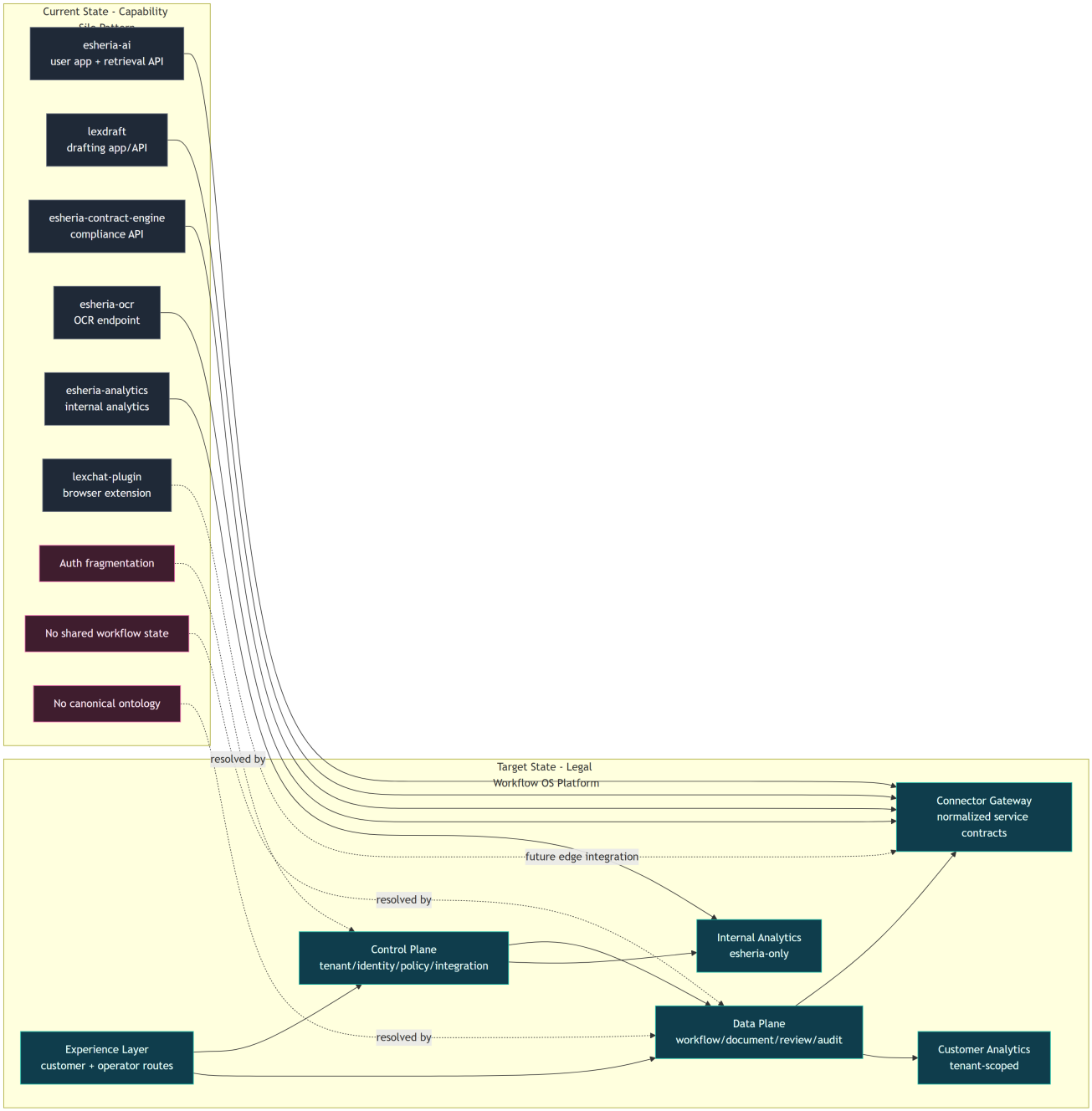

Figure 11: *

Figure G — Transition from isolated capabilities to unified platform

Executive Interpretation

Transformation is additive: capability repos stay operational while platform value accumulates above them.